

Tiva Rocco

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[Linkedin](#) | [Personal Portfolio](#)

EDUCATION

North Carolina State University – Raleigh, NC

Ph.D. in Computer Science

Aug 2025 – Expected May 2030

Research Interests

- CS Education, Software Engineering

California State University, Monterey Bay – Seaside, CA

BS in Computer Science - Software Engineering

Aug 2021 – December 2024

EXPERIENCE

AI & Organizational Skills Instructor – Catalyst Program, NC State Science House, Raleigh, NC

July 2026

- Developed and taught two sessions on using AI for organizational skills, time management, and assignments to 30 high school students with disabilities

STEM Research Mentor – Blackwell Research Institute

March 2026 – Present

- Guide students on reading scientific literature, forming research questions, writing a literature review, and submitting for publication

Graduate Research Assistant – NC State University, Raleigh, NC

Jan 2026 – Present

- Conduct CS education & software engineering research under advisement of Dr. Sarah Heckman in the WISER lab

Software Engineering Graduate TA – NC State University, Raleigh, NC

Aug 2025 – Present

- Lead lab instruction for 60+ students, grade assignments, hold office hours to enhance student development and periodically deliver full lectures

K-12 Mathematics, Reading, & Writing Tutor – Watsonville Tutoring Club, Watsonville, CA

Oct 2023 – June 2025

- Implemented a curriculum tailored to students' level of knowledge and goals for ages 5-17 in various subjects

Senior Coordinator, CSUMB TA++ Program – CSU-Monterey Bay, Seaside, CA

Jan 2024 – Dec 2024

- Offered mentorship and support for new and existing computer science TA's
- Held 3-5 training sessions per semester on TA expectations, ethics, and technical skills

Undergraduate Research Assistant – CSU-Monterey Bay, Seaside, CA

May 2024 – Dec 2024

- Developed software to engage student learning on computational complexity through visualization of energy consumption and environmental impacts of code
- Served as codebase manager offering debugging support to research team and overseeing workflows
- Funded by the Undergraduate Research Opportunities Center under the advisement of Dr. Joshua Gross

Internet Programming TA – CSU-Monterey Bay, Seaside, CA

Oct 2023 – Dec 2024

- Assisted professor in leading lab instruction, graded assignments & exams, held office hours

CONFERENCES & PUBLICATIONS

LearnLab Summer School, Educational Data Mining Track – Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh, PA

July 2026

Participant

SIGCSE – St. Louis, MO

Feb 2026

Student Volunteer

CCSC-NW – Willamette University, Salem, OR

Oct 2024

Rocco, T. & Gross, J.B. (2024) Debugging Server- and Client-Side JavaScript. *Journal of Computing Sciences in Colleges*, 40(2), 18-20. [Conference Tutorial, CCSC-NW, Willamette University, Salem, OR]

CERTIFICATIONS & AWARDS

Teaching Certificate, Advanced – NCSU Graduate School, Raleigh, NC

In Progress

Outstanding Graduate TA Award – NCSU ACM Chapter, Raleigh, NC

April 2026

Teaching Certificate – NCSU Graduate School, Raleigh, NC

March 2026

LEADERSHIP & SERVICE

Mobile App Developer – NC State Helping Hands Project, Raleigh, NC

March 2026 - Present

- Volunteer developer building low-cost prosthetic hands for children, contributing to the complete iOS/Android mobile application from the ground up using React Native and TypeScript

- Built real-time Bluetooth Low Energy communication between the app and an Arduino-powered prosthetic, enabling children ages 7-12 to monitor their device's sensor activity, signal strength, and connection health

Workshop Organizer & Instructor – *NC State University, Raleigh, NC* *Nov 2025 - Present*

- Organize and lead GitHub-based personal portfolio workshops with institutional backing from the NC State Computing Success Center and ACM chapter, providing technical and professional development support for computing students

Women in Computer Science Mentor – *NC State University, Raleigh, NC* *Sep 2025 - May 2026*

- Serve three undergraduate and one graduate student as mentor and meet 2+ times per month to discuss coursework, career planning, and strategies for success to support confidence in computing

Web Development Student Volunteer – *Community Builders of Monterey Bay, Seaside, CA* *Aug 2023 - Oct 2023*

- Developed new site aimed at increasing youth involvement within the community using JavaScript, HTML, and CSS

Web Development Student Volunteer – *Life Lab, Santa Cruz, CA* *Jan 2023 - May 2023*

- Led modernization and updates of the lab's website during a hosting platform migration